Food Assistance Outlook Brief: Projected food assistance needs in January 2027

July 2026

Lebanon	1.0-1.49 million	**1.0-1.49 million**	20-25%	**Higher***	*Similar**	Conflict, economy	Crisis (IPC Phase 3)
			Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected to persist across most of the country through January due to ongoing insecurity, displacement, infrastructure damage, and disruptions to livelihoods and markets. Despite broadly stable national food supply, high prices and reduced income-earning opportunities will continue to erode household purchasing power and constrain access to food.				
Burkina Faso	1.0-1.49 million	**750,000-999,999**	less than 5%	*Similar*	**Lower**	Conflict, weather	Crisis (IPC Phase 3)
			In January, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected in Karo-Peli Province where conflict continues to restrict access to fields and livelihoods and markets remain dependent on irregular military-escorted convoys. Somewhat improved harvests and market supply are expected to keep needs below the five-year average, but production and household income will remain below pre-crisis levels.				
Nepal	1.0-1.49 million	**750,000-999,999**	less than 5%	**Lower***	**Lower***	Weather, economy	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)
			Needs are expected to peak between July and September as households affected by prior floods, landslides, and earthquakes continue to recover, while high fuel prices and disruptions to the tea trade constrain purchasing power and labor income. By January, food and income from the October harvest are expected to support mainly Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes and reduce needs				
Zambia	250,000-499,999	**500,000-749,999**	less than 5%	**Lower***	**Lower***	Weather	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)
			In January, Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are expected in parts of southwestern and eastern Zambia, where El Niño-related rainfall deficits during 2026/27 cultivation are expected to reduce agricultural labor demand and income. Although needs will rise seasonally, above-average food stocks from the 2026 harvest are expected to support food access and keep needs below last year and the five-year average.				
Burundi	500,000-749,999	**500,000-749,999**	5-10%	*Similar*	*Similar*	Economy, weather, refugee/returnee influx	Crisis (IPC Phase 3)
			In January, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected in the Northern Lowlands, and Stressed (IPC Phase 2) in the Eastern Lowlands, Imbo Plains, and Eastern Dry Plateaus. The Season A green harvest will begin in January, but restricted cross-border opportunities, competition from refugees and returnees, high fuel prices, and extremely low local wages in the north will slow improvement in food consumption.				
Central African Republic	750,000-999,999	**500,000-749,999**	10-15%	*Similar**	*Similar**	Conflict	Crisis (IPC Phase 3)
			Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected to persist through January despite seasonal improvements from the ongoing harvest in northern areas. Insecurity, prolonged displacement, disrupted livelihoods, and limited market access in conflict-affected areas of the northwest, northeast, and southeast are expected to continue constraining food access, while high food prices further reduce purchasing power.				
Mali	1.5-1.99 million	**500,000-749,999**	less than 5%	*Similar*	**Higher**	Conflict, weather	Emergency (IPC Phase 4)
			In January, main and off-season harvests are expected to support seasonal improvements in food access across southern Mali. However, persistent insecurity, displacement, economic disruptions, and high food prices are expected to continue limiting household purchasing power and food access in central and northern Mali, keeping needs high and similar to last year. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected to persist in Kidal due to severe market and trade disruptions, while Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected in Ménaka, where below-average harvests will support only partial improvement in food access.				
Honduras	500,000-749,999	**500,000-749,999**	5-10%	*Similar**	*Similar**	Weather	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)
			By January, most poor households are likely to experience Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes as below-average production and high costs will put pressure on household budgets, limiting seasonal gains.				
Côte d'Ivoire	500,000-749,999	**500,000-749,999**	less than 5%	*Similar**	*Similar**	Conflict, economy	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)
			Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are likely to persist among refugees and host communities through January, as pressure on limited food, farmland, and services will continue, despite seasonal harvests.				
El Salvador	250,000-499,999	**100,000-249,999**	less than 5%	*Similar**	*Similar**	Weather	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)
			Most poor rural households are expected to remain Stressed (IPC Phase 2) through January as below-average harvests and limited household food stocks outweigh seasonal labor income.				
Togo	250,000-499,999	**100,000-249,999**	less than 5%	*Similar**	*Similar**	Conflict, refugee influx	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)
			In January, Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are likely in northern areas, where insecurity disrupts livelihoods despite improved access to food from the main harvest and seasonally lower market prices.				
Lesotho	<100,000	**100,000-249,999**	5-10%	*Similar**	*Similar**	Weather	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)
			Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are expected in the Senqu River Valley, Southern Lowlands, and Mountain regions, as a forecasted late start of the rains will likely reduce agricultural labor income.				

IPC (Version 3.1) Acute Food Insecurity Reference Table for Area Classification

Minimal (IPC Phase 1)	Stressed (IPC Phase 2)	Crisis (IPC Phase 3)	Emergency (IPC Phase 4)	Famine (IPC Phase 5)
Households are able to meet essential food and non-food needs without engaging in atypical and unsustainable strategies to access food and income.	Households have minimally adequate food consumption but are unable to afford some essential non-food expenditures without engaging in stress-coping strategies.	Households either: Have food consumption gaps which are reflected by high or above-usual acute malnutrition; - or - Are marginally able to meet minimum food needs but only by depleting essential livelihood assets or through crisis-coping strategies.	Households either: Have large food consumption gaps which are reflected in very high acute malnutrition and excess mortality; - or - Are able to mitigate large food consumption gaps but only by employing emergency livelihood strategies and asset liquidation.	Households have an extreme lack of food and/or other basic needs even after full employment of coping strategies. Starvation, death, destitution, and extremely critical acute malnutrition levels are evident. (For Famine Classification, area needs to have extreme critical levels of acute malnutrition and mortality.)

! Indicates area would likely be at least one phase worse without current or planned humanitarian food assistance.

Urgent Action Required

FEWS NET assesses and communicates a "risk of Famine" when there is one or more credible alternative scenarios in which Famine (IPC Phase 5) is likely to occur but is not the most likely acute food insecurity outcome. When multiple credible alternative scenarios exist that would likely lead to Famine, FEWS NET encourages communicating these scenarios when planning for and responding to food crises. Consult FEWS NET's reports to understand alternative scenarios; risk of Famine is not captured in regular food security mapping in order to maintain clarity about the most likely scenario. The IPC follows different guidance to assess a risk of Famine, which can be found here.